(*The Statesman*, 16 December 1988)

The trial before the commission moved briskly after the arrival of K. T. S. Tulsi on the scene. Kiran stood for cross-examination after the lawyers had deposed, and she faced the barrage of questions for a full week in the dock.

In the end the commission gave its report in April 1990, finding fault with Kiran, all the police officers involved and the lawyers who had gone on strike as well as with the politicians for their motivation of the crowds. The matter today rests at this stage. Kiran moved soon thereafter to Mizoram (a hard posting); the policemen said that they were not much bothered by all this and the lawyers (some of them) continued their strike now for other reasons. Justice Wadhwa returned to his bench to the relief of the waiting litigants.

No Punitive Action Proposed
Wadhwa Panel Censures All

The much-awaited Wadhwa [Commission] report, set up to go into the events leading to the longest ever lawyers' strike, is believed to have censured police officers, lawyers and politicians but has recommended no punitive measures against anybody.

Its findings assume significance especially after the latest incident in which a police officer allegedly misbehaved with an additional district sessions judge, sparking off a strike in the lower courts in the Capital.

The Wadhwa Commission which submitted its final report last month is yet to be made public and is likely to be placed before Parliament in the forthcoming budget session.

Mrs Kiran Bedi, then DCP (North), is learnt to have been indicted for her role in the lathicharge of lawyers, which took place outside her office on 21 January 1988, when lawyers collected, protesting against the handcuffing of a colleague.

The report has also found the role of certain lawyers suspect and adverse comments have been passed also on Mr Rajesh Agnihotri, whose arrest was the genesis of the strike.

Some politicians, both from the Congress (I) and the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) have also been named for their involvement in the 99-day strike by lawyers, sources said.

Police officers have been censured for dereliction of duty when crowds from Samaypur Badli entered the Tis Hazari court complex on 17 February 1988 leading to violence.

The report, which is reportedly exhaustive, has gone into all details of the lawyers' agitation in 1988 but has not recommended any punishment, sources claimed.

The two-judge commission was set up by the Lt. Governor, under an administrative order, to go into events leading to the lawyers' strike which began on 15 January 1988.

In April 1988, the commission had submitted its interim report to the Lt. Governor, which was duly placed before Parliament. It had recommended the transfer of Mrs Kiran Bedi and four other officers, in the interest of investigations. What it had also recommended was that a CBI inquiry be initiated to go into events of the lathicharge and the violence in the court complex.

The final report does not include the findings of the CBI inquiry. It was to be headed by a DIG, Mr Jaspal Singh. The findings of the CBI investigations could be contrary to the Wadhwa report.

'There has been no severe indictment on anybody but aspersions have been cast on several